Notes made to prepare for interviews, October 2026

# Aladdin Studio, learned with AI

What public sources show about Studio, and directions to explore for marketing it

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Independent analysis from public sources with AI agents. Not produced, reviewed or endorsed by BlackRock.

# Executive summary

## Studio is the layer of Aladdin that clients build on.

Studio is Aladdin's developer and data layer, with three parts: APIs and events, Aladdin Data Cloud on Snowflake, and developer tools. Five BlackRock speakers have defined it on the record, and four give these same three parts[1].

BlackRock's investor story and its buyers' own answers both point to Studio. API calls are the fastest-growing measure BlackRock showed investors: 17x by 2030. Buyers at BlackRock's webinar want a core platform plus their own builds, and rivals already sell to that demand[2]. Part 3 puts the findings together into one way of presenting Studio, and the marketing work that follows.

### What this method can and cannot do

**Public material only:** BlackRock web pages, the 54 API specifications inside 11 public `asdk_plugin` Python packages, 128 recordings, SEC filings, procurement notices, GitHub and PyPI. AI agents pulled them in about a day; I checked every fact against its document. Some recordings are machine-transcribed, so names and jargon can be misheard. I have no internal product context, so some conclusions may be wrong for reasons I cannot see.

### How to read the receipts

Underlined text links to the document behind the fact. Each superscript number points to an entry in Sources, at the end of this document, giving the grade (P, S or T), title, speaker and date.

■ **P** Primary document: a filing, a specification, a web page or press release, a procurement notice, or code on GitHub or PyPI

■ **S** BlackRock speaker on the record, with the name and title as the recording gives them

□ **T** Third-party report: trade press, or a third party's summary of a primary source

Part 1

# What the public record shows

Aladdin is the investment platform BlackRock built for itself and sells to other institutions. Brennan Rosales, its AI Engineering Lead, put the scale this way at a LangChain conference in 2025. "BlackRock is the biggest user of Aladdin, but we also sell and support hundreds of clients globally across 70 countries." The organization is "around 7,000 people, with over 4,000 of those being engineers." They maintain "around 100 Aladdin front-end applications"[3]. BlackRock's technology services and subscription revenue was $2.0 billion in 2025, up 24 percent including Preqin, the private-markets data firm bought in 2025[4]. BlackRock sells the platform as one engine with separate entry points, and Studio is the entry point for people who write code.

## What BlackRock sells

### Exhibit 1. Of Aladdin's eight named products, Studio is the one for people who write code

| Product | What it does | Main users |
|---|---|---|
| **Aladdin** | The front-to-back system for public markets, the same system BlackRock runs internally[3] | Asset managers, insurers, pension funds, banks |
| **Aladdin Wealth** | Portfolio risk analysis and proposals for advisors. Its AI "auto commentary" tool launched in October 2025, with Morgan Stanley as the first client[5] | Wealth managers and private banks |
| **eFront** | A private-fund investment platform covering due diligence through cash flows and reporting. Preqin now sits inside eFront Insight, and private credit analytics were added on Preqin in May 2026[6] | Investors in funds and fund managers |
| **Aladdin Studio** | **The developer and data layer. It covers APIs and events, Aladdin Data Cloud, and developer tools. BlackRock calls it "API-first" and names three users: "a professional engineer building new workflow applications, a code-curious portfolio manager extracting investment insights, or a data analyst automating reporting"[7]** | **Client engineers, data analysts, code-curious portfolio managers** |
| **Aladdin Data Cloud** | A managed data service on Snowflake that puts Aladdin and outside data in one place. It is sold as an add-on to Aladdin Enterprise[8]. Richard Newman, General Manager, Aladdin Studio, calls it "part of Studio"[9] | Data teams |
| **Aladdin Copilot** | A chat assistant "now available to all Aladdin clients" that "will not give investment advice"[10] | All platform users |
| **Aladdin Accounting** | Investment accounting and performance. Its public APIs cover configuration, valuations, lots and composites[11] | Asset managers and asset owners |
| **Aladdin Provider** | Connects custodians and administrators to a client's Aladdin. The providers pay BlackRock to use it[12] | Custodians and administrators |

Source: BlackRock product pages[7, 10, 13]; Amazon press release, December 2025[8]; iShares prospectus[12]; the public specifications[11].

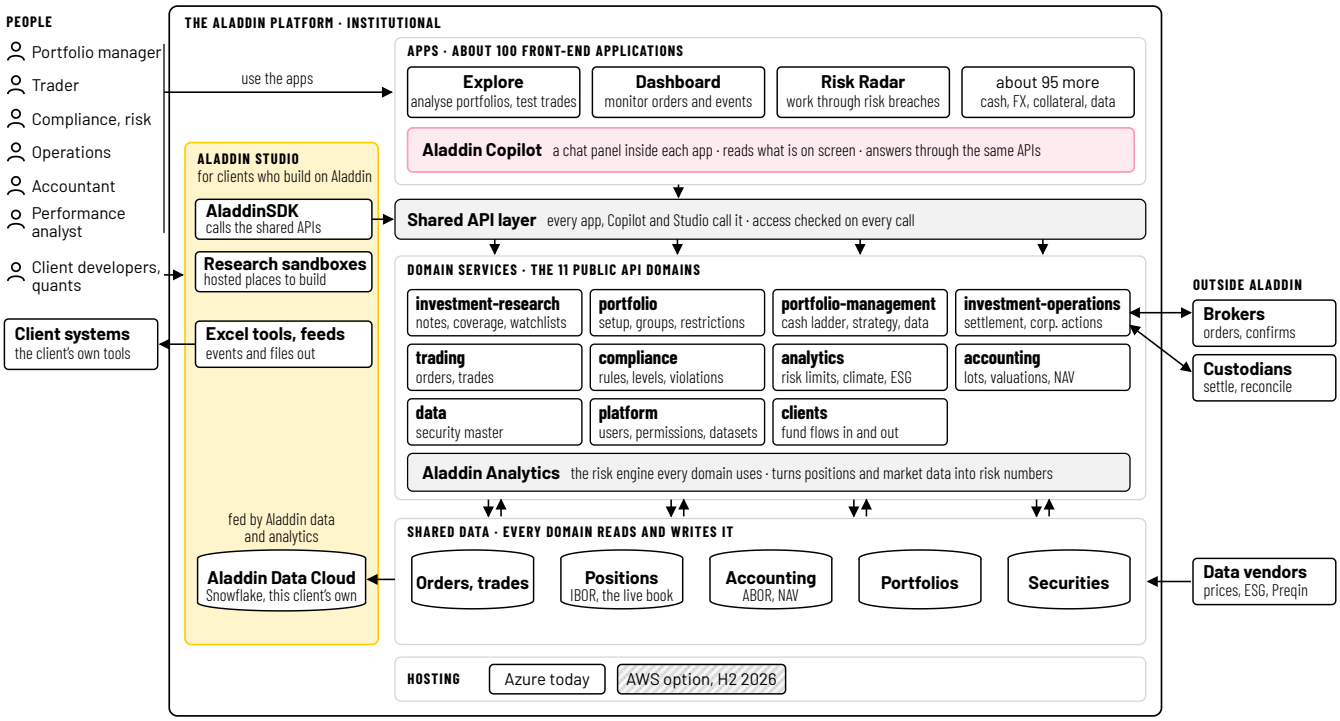
Exhibit 2 follows one trade through Aladdin, step by step, as far as the 54 public specifications describe it[11, 14].

## Exhibit 2. The public APIs follow a trade from order to NAV

| Step | Who acts | Product or application BlackRock names | API that covers it |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 **Order** | The portfolio manager. An order is "a directive from a portfolio manager to the trading desk to execute a particular investment decision" (Order spec)[11] | The Explore application: its "new what-if model" (Explore classroom recording) compares a changed portfolio with the original before anything is traded[15] | `OrderAPI` v1 (stable). Posting an order takes `whatIf` and `runCompliance`. Its example statuses run "Open," "Compl Pending," "Authorized," "Active," "Booked"[11] |
| 2 **Compliance check** | No one. The check runs automatically when the order is posted, because `runCompliance` is on by default. Any violation then carries an owner, a disposition and a resolution comment[11] | Rules "automatically monitor whether a fund adheres to a regulation, client mandate, or internal guideline" (ComplianceRule spec); no application is named[11] | `ComplianceRuleAPI` and `ViolationAPI` v1 (alpha). Violations are "generated at time of the compliance breach" (Violation spec). A check that times out posts the order as "Compl Pending"[11] |
| 3 **Trade** | The trading desk. Operations then confirms it, because "after a trade is booked in Aladdin, it needs to be confirmed with broker" (BrokerConfirmRouting spec)[11] | Schneid or Shannon of Aladdin Accounting describes the run as going "from that first order through the trade, through all the operation protocols into accounting without lifting up the pencil"[14] | `TradeAPI` v2 (alpha). A block trade carries its per-portfolio trades, plus `confirmedWith` and `confirmedBy`. `BrokerConfirmRoutingAPI` routes the confirm[11] |
| 4 **Position in the IBOR** | The investment team, whose live book is the IBOR, the investment book of record. Richard Newman, Studio's general manager: "It does start with IBOR"[9] | Aladdin Data Cloud, where users "can access their Investment Books of Record (IBOR), Accounting Books of Record (ABOR) holdings" (Fivetran's blog)[16] | None of the 54 is a position API. Positions appear only as fields: a positions source in `PortfolioToolkitAPI`, and a violation's "underlying positions" (Violation spec)[11] |
| 5 **Lot in the ABOR** | The accounting team, which says of itself: "we are data managers more than anything else" (Schneid or Shannon)[14] | Aladdin Accounting, named in the portfolio-configuration specification[11] | `AborLotAPI` v1 (alpha). ABOR lots, the accounting book of record, are "retrieved from the ledger_a_summary table" (AborLot spec)[11] |
| 6 **NAV** | Accounting, whose clients are "CFOs, they're controllers, they're heads of performance" (Schneid or Shannon)[14] | Aladdin Accounting; each valuation carries an exception list[11] | `ValuationsAPI` v1, beta: valuations "generated for various processes at the portfolio/portfolio group level" (Valuations spec)[11] |

■ Source: the public specifications named in each cell[11]; Newman[9]; the Explore training recording[15]; the Aladdin Accounting episode with David Schneid and Daniel Shannon, which does not label who is speaking[14]; Fivetran[16]. The specifications name no order screen and hold no position or event API, and they do not say in what sequence steps 4 to 6 happen. The labels in brackets are each specification's stability label: alpha is the earliest, then beta, stable and sunset; Exhibit 5 counts them.

## Exhibit 3. Apps, Copilot and Studio all call one shared API layer




**For illustrative purposes only.** ■ Source: about 100 apps, with Copilot in all of them, Rosales and Vicente Valdez at 2:35[3]. The 11 domains behind the shared layer are the packages of BlackRock's public SDK, named as in its specifications[11, 17]. App names other than Explore come from field descriptions in those specifications, so their screens are not drawn[11, 15]. Aladdin Analytics is the name the risk specifications give the engine[11]. Studio, Woodhead at 4:49[1]; Excel tools and feeds, the APIs page[18]; Data Cloud fed by Aladdin data and analytics[1, 13]; hosting[19, 8]. Solid outline = shown in sources; hatched = announced, not live.

## Exhibit 4. Six pieces make up Studio

| Piece | What it is, in plain words |
|---|---|
| **APIs (Aladdin Graph)** | Ways for a program to read and write Aladdin data. Aladdin Graph is the whole API layer, not one API: every public specification carries an id of the form `agraph.<domain>.<segment>.<group>.v1.<API>`[11]. |
| **Event-driven APIs** | Aladdin tells a program when something happens. Woodhead names "APIs events" as one part[1]; Diwakar Goel, Global Head of Data, Aladdin, wants "every single transaction … via an event, via an API"[20]. |
| **Aladdin Data Cloud** | A managed data store on Snowflake, with Fivetran moving the data. Goel puts its latency at "within 15 minutes"[20]. |
| **Aladdin Compute** | A hosted space where developers run Python next to their Aladdin data; the SDK has a run mode for "Aladdin Studio Compute sessions"[17]. |
| **Aladdin SDK** | An open-source Python library that handles login, retries, rate limits, pagination and long-running operations[17]. Eleven add-on packages, one per API domain, are generated from the specifications by BlackRock's plugin builder[21]. |
| **Developer Portal and Data Dictionary** | The API catalog, framework guides, field dictionary, notebooks and code samples the APIs page describes. |

■ Source: BlackRock Studio and APIs pages[7, 18]; the 54 public specifications and SDK README[11, 17]; Woodhead[1] and Goel[20]. No event specification is public[11]; the catalog, guides, notebooks and samples sit behind a client login[18].

### Exhibit 5. Two domains hold 127 of the 301 public API operations

| Domain | Specs | Operations | Alpha | Beta | Stable | Sunset | Largest APIs by operations |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Investment operations** | 15 | **74** | 9 | 4 | 2 | – | PrincipalInterestFactor, CounterPartySettlementInstruction, MiscellaneousCashflow, CouponReset and 11 more |
| **Analytics** | 9 | **53** | – | – | 8 | 1 | RiskRule, RiskWorkflow, RiskException, RiskConfig and 5 more |
| **Investment research** | 5 | **41** | 5 | – | – | – | AnalystCoverage, Criterion, Watchlist, ResearchNote and 1 more |
| **Platform** | 6 | **29** | 2 | – | 4 | – | AdcDataset, UserGroup, User, UserGroupPermission and 2 more |
| **Portfolio management** | 4 | **28** | 1 | – | 3 | – | CIDWriter, Strategy, CIDReader, CashLadder |
| **Portfolio** | 3 | **23** | 1 | – | 2 | – | PortfolioGroup, RestrictedAsset, PortfolioToolkit |
| **Data** | 1 | **15** | – | – | 1 | – | SecurityCreation |
| **Trading** | 2 | **14** | 1 | – | 1 | – | Order, Trade |
| **Compliance** | 4 | **9** | 3 | – | 1 | – | ComplianceRuleAssignment, Violation, ComplianceRule, Level |
| **Accounting** | 4 | **8** | 2 | 2 | – | – | PortfolioConfiguration, Valuations, CompositeMembership, AborLot |
| **Clients** | 1 | **7** | – | – | 1 | – | EnrichedCapitalFlow |
| **Total** | **54** | **301** | **24** | **6** | **23** | **1** | 11 domains, 11 PyPI packages |

■ Source: the 54 Swagger 2.0 specifications inside the 11 `asdk_plugin` packages, version 2.0.0b3, on PyPI[11]. Counts are mine, recomputed from the files. The core `aladdinsdk` package adds four utility APIs (token, subscription, notification and a demo), not counted here. Alpha, beta, stable and sunset are the stability labels each specification carries (its `x-aladdin-api-stability` field), alpha being the earliest; the four columns count specs by label.

The specifications say more than Exhibit 5's counts: they show how the APIs behave. Posting an order takes `whatIf` and `runCompliance`, which defaults to true, and the response returns any compliance violations inline[11]. Ten specifications expose an endpoint for long-running operations, 35 operations are flagged as long-running, and the SDK polls them[17]. Risk exceptions and Data Cloud datasets carry bitemporal fields, which record two time dimensions. Rule assignments and dataset releases name a four-eyes approval, a second sign-off[11]. Every request carries an application key plus OAuth 2.0 scopes such as `trading.order_management.order.v1.Order:read`, and the client ID and secret come from the Studio UI[17].

## What Studio is

Five BlackRock speakers define Studio in the 128 recordings I pulled for this document[22, 23]; Exhibit 6 lists each with the title the recording gives. BlackRock's own definition comes from the head of Studio engineering, on Snowflake's podcast in November 2025.

> "So we think about Aladdin today as a platform and Aladdin Studio is essentially the user experience that allows people to think of Aladdin as a platform. It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake takes all of that information that's generated through our analytics factory and inside of Aladdin and pushes that into Snowflake. And increasingly we're building a set of developer tools."
>
> — Dave Woodhead, Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio, Snowflake Data Cloud podcast, published November 11, 2025[1]

### Exhibit 6. Five BlackRock executives have defined Studio on the record

| Speaker | Title, as the recording gives it | What they add to the definition | Recording |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Dave Woodhead** | Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio | Gives the three-part definition quoted above | Snowflake podcast, November 2025[1] |
| **Richard Newman** | General Manager, Aladdin Studio | Data Cloud is "part of Studio"; analytics APIs "releasing soon … all part of the Studio umbrella" | Never Done podcast, January 2025[9] |
| **Diwakar Goel** | Global Head of Data, Aladdin | Every transaction "via an event, via an API"; Data Cloud "within 15 minutes of latency" | Pensions webinar, 2025[20] |
| **Kunal Khara** | Managing Director and Global Head of Aladdin Product | Named "the Aladdin studio estate" as a 2024 focus, meaning programmatic access "at machine scale" | Awards interview, early 2024[24] |
| **Jeff Miller** | Managing Director, Global Head of Data Platform and Product Engineering | Data Cloud replaced "flat files … FTP and related transfers" | Snowflake video, undated[25] |

Source: the recordings cited in the Recording column. Quotations are verbatim from the transcripts; three of the five are machine transcriptions, marked as such in the Sources section at the end of this document.

Four of the five describe Studio with the same three parts. Newman calls Data Cloud "part of Studio"[9]. Goel describes events, APIs and a near-real-time data store[20]. Khara calls it programmatic access to data and reporting[24]. A 2026 job posting calls Studio "Aladdin's extensibility layer"[26]. The message is consistent across speakers and years, so BlackRock already has a positioning for Studio. Learning about it from outside takes effort. The catalog has to be unpacked from packages. The definitions have to be transcribed from recordings.

### Exhibit 7. All four speakers name APIs, events and the Data Cloud as parts of Studio

| Speaker, date | What they said | APIs and events | Data Cloud | Developer tools |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Kunal Khara, early 2024** | "More users are craving this ability to interact with our data, with their data, with reporting with dashboards on a programmatic basis"[24] | **Yes** | **Yes** | – |
| **Richard Newman, January 2025** | "The Aladdin data cloud … which is part of Studio"; "those analytic APIs … That's all part of the Studio umbrella"[9] | **Yes** | **Yes** | – |
| **Diwakar Goel, 2025** | "Every single transaction … via an event, via an API"; "a near real time data store"; exposing "the software and application that we're building"[20] | **Yes** | **Yes** | **Yes** |
| **Dave Woodhead, November 2025** | "It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake … developer tools"[1] | **Yes** | **Yes** | **Yes** |

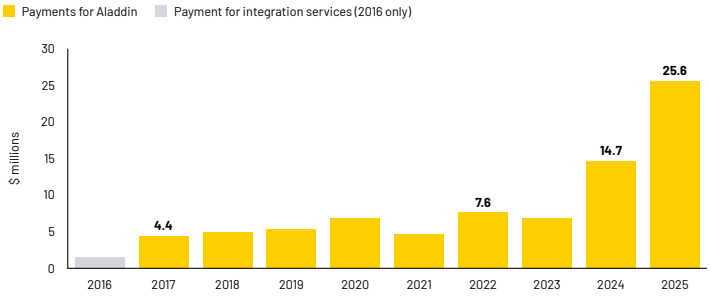
Source: the four recordings cited[24, 9, 20, 1]. Quotations are verbatim; Khara, Goel and Woodhead are machine or auto-caption transcriptions, marked as such in the Sources section at the end of this document. Yes means the speaker names that part; – means not. Only Goel and Woodhead name developer tools.

Part 2

# 1. The public record of clients using Aladdin can serve as Studio's proof

BlackRock's Studio page names no client building on Studio[7], and a full-text search of SEC EDGAR finds no filing that mentions Studio[27]. Proof that clients use Aladdin, though, is public. On BlackRock's video, Royal London's chief executive credits Aladdin's Snowflake implementation[28]. JPMorgan Chase's proxy statements report Aladdin payments of $4.4 million to $7.6 million a year from 2017 to 2023, then $14.7 million in 2024 and $25.6 million in 2025[29, 30].

### Exhibit 8. JPMorgan Chase's payments for Aladdin rose from under $8 million a year to $25.6 million in 2025




Source: JPMorgan Chase proxy statements (DEF 14A) filed 2017 to 2026[29, 30]. The chart plots each payment in the year it was made. The grey 2016 bar is a payment for integration services; the figures in the text start with 2017. JPMorgan is also a custodian, so the payments may cover more than a client license. In 2016 it said it was connecting to Aladdin for custody clients[31]. That 2016 report is trade press, not a JPMorgan or BlackRock document.

A second kind of record is code written by a client's engineers. In December 2025 an engineer at a client firm submitted two changes to the open-source SDK: URL rewriting and custom headers. Both are for firms that route Aladdin calls through an enterprise gateway. The BlackRock engineer who co-wrote the SDK's launch post merged them[32, 33, 34, 35]. Janus Henderson's 10-K says that in the third quarter of 2025 the firm chose to move its investment management system to Aladdin, "a complex, multi-year initiative"[36]. Public buyers add a third kind of record: procurement notices.

### Exhibit 9. Aladdin won the tenders of three public pension bodies

| Buyer | Year | Outcome |
|---|---|---|
| **UK Pension Protection Fund**[37] | 2025 | Aladdin won both parts of the tender, at a price above the fund's own estimate |
| **Nest (UK)**[38] | 2023 | Aladdin won against six other bids |
| **US Pension Benefit Guaranty Corporation**[39] | 2017 and 2023 | Aladdin won in 2017 and again in 2023, at an unchanged price |

Source: UK Find a Tender[37, 38]; USAspending.gov[39].

None of this proof names Studio, which matters less than it seems. Studio is sold for building custom applications on Aladdin, so a buyer wants to know that another institution built on the platform and stayed. Proof from one firm counts even when the buyer is a different kind of firm. Public pension funds, and firms whose filings or tenders already name BlackRock, are easier to name in public. So they are the natural first candidates for a named Studio story.

**What this finding suggests about direction.** A named Studio story can start with clients whose Aladdin use is already on the record.

## 2. BlackRock's growth story to investors runs through Studio, though it rarely says the name

BlackRock tells investors growth will come from API calls, without naming the product behind them. It projected at its 2025 Investor Day that API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin would grow 17x by 2030[40]. Attributing them to Studio is my inference[40]. I make that inference because API use is the activity the Studio page describes[7]. No executive said "Studio" on any of the 26 earnings calls from the first quarter of 2020 to the second quarter of 2026[41]. Outside the calls, the only investor-facing mention I found is a single line on a 2023 Investor Day slide[42]. BlackRock's 10-K says technology services fees are generally set by the value of positions on the platform or at a fixed rate. They can also depend on subscriptions, go-lives and support. The 10-K does not list API calls among the fee terms it names[4, 40].

**Exhibit 10. No BlackRock executive said "Studio" on any of 26 earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026**

| Term | Mentions | Where it came up |
|---|---|---|
| **Studio** | **0** | **Never on a call. The only investor-facing mention found is one line on a 2023 Investor Day slide[42]** |
| **Data Cloud** | 2 | Q3 2022[43] and Q4 2024[44], where it was described as an add-on sold with Aladdin Enterprise |
| **API** | 1 | Q4 2021: "clients are really looking to use both data and APIs"[45] |
| **Copilot** | 1 | Q4 2023: "investments in Aladdin AI copilots"[46] |
| **Citizen developer** | 0 | Never |
| **Agent** | 0 | Never |

Source: third-party transcripts of BlackRock earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026[41]. My tally. The non-zero counts add up to about four mentions in six and a half years. A zero means the term appears in no transcript; the non-zero counts are approximate.

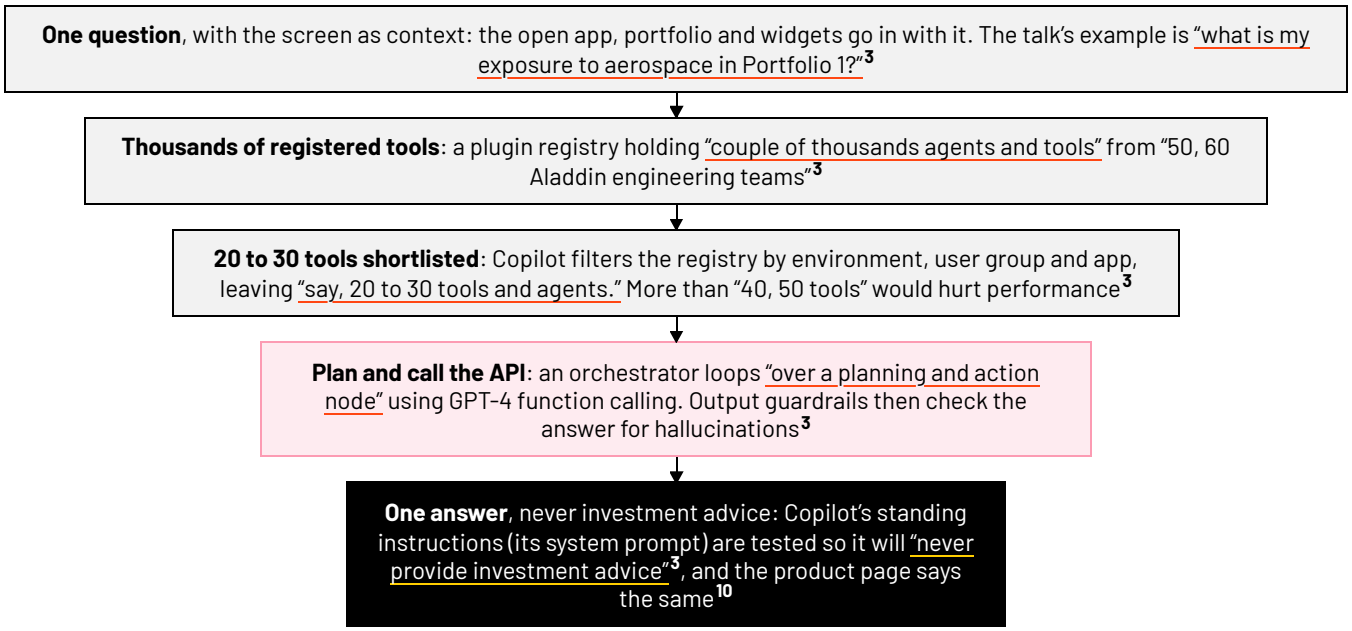
The private-markets data BlackRock has been adding reaches clients through Data Cloud and Explore. BlackRock bought eFront in 2019 and Preqin in 2025. In September 2025 its private markets team described the result on a client webinar[47]. Investors "now have access to over 15,000 fund investments within eFront Insight" for benchmarking. Preqin indices "are also available today in Aladdin Explore and our Aladdin Data Cloud capabilities". And "over 10 different transaction types" were added to Aladdin, covering commitments, fundings, paydowns and PIK, so private credit loans are captured natively. The team said those were designed with BlackRock's own professionals and "our new colleagues from HPS"[47]. Private credit analytics on Preqin followed in May 2026[6]. Newman, the Studio general manager, names eFront data and Preqin among the data being added to Data Cloud[9].

**What this finding suggests about direction.** BlackRock itself says growth will come from API calls, the fastest-growing measure it showed investors. The data it is adding, private markets and Preqin, arrives through Data Cloud and Explore. Both are Studio surfaces.

# 3. Aladdin's AI answers inside the login; data providers let outside AI tools reach their data

Aladdin Copilot, the AI inside the login, is built on the same APIs Studio exposes. It draws on a registry of plugins, "couple of thousands agents and tools," built by Aladdin's engineering teams. The first way a team adds a tool is "to define a tool as kind of mapping one-to-one to an existing Aladdin API already out in production"[3]. So Copilot's tools are Studio's APIs. Microsoft's Adrian Crockett made the dependence plain on BlackRock's podcast: "There's no copilot without plug-ins"[48]. On the data side, BlackRock's AI product head says the team is making sure "the data model itself is structured for agentic use cases"[49].

**Exhibit 11. Copilot answers a question by choosing from thousands of tools and calling production Aladdin APIs**




Source: Rosales and Valdez at LangChain Interrupt 2025[3]; the Copilot page[10]. The tool counts are the speakers' own approximations; the talk is a machine transcription, marked as such in the Sources section.

Exhibit 12 lists what the providers a Studio buyer compares have made public about AI access. Six data and cloud providers that Studio buyers also use offer a connector or an MCP server, and two system-of-record rivals have announced AI features. LSEG had 90 customers connected by April 2026, according to a secondary summary of its results slides[50, 51].

**Exhibit 12. Of nine providers a Studio buyer compares, eight have announced AI features or AI access to their data**

| Provider | What is public | Receipt |
|---|---|---|
| **System-of-record rivals** | | |
| **SimCorp** | Agent Launchpad, announced in 2026, is to offer prebuilt AI agents and let clients build their own on SimCorp One's data layer | SimCorp news[52] |
| **Arcesium** | Arcesium added AI features to Aquata and announced an AI platform | Arcesium press releases[53, 54] |
| **Data and cloud providers** | | |
| **FactSet** | FactSet runs an MCP server for its data and calls it the first in its market | FactSet press release[55] |
| **LSEG** | LSEG has announced a collaboration with Anthropic and an MCP server. It had 90 customers connected by April 2026 | LSEG press release[51]; Investing.com summary[50] |
| **MSCI** | MSCI offers "AI connectors" to its proprietary data | MSCI press release[56] |
| **S&P Global** | S&P Global added Credit Ratings to its AI Data Portal in September 2026 | S&P Global press release[57] |
| **Snowflake** | Snowflake documents an MCP server for Cortex Agents | Snowflake documentation[58] |
| **Databricks** | Databricks documents managed MCP servers | Databricks documentation[59] |
| **Aladdin** | **A Forward Deploy Engineer posting for Aladdin Data names "Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agents, and Copilot extensions"** | **BlackRock Careers[60]** |

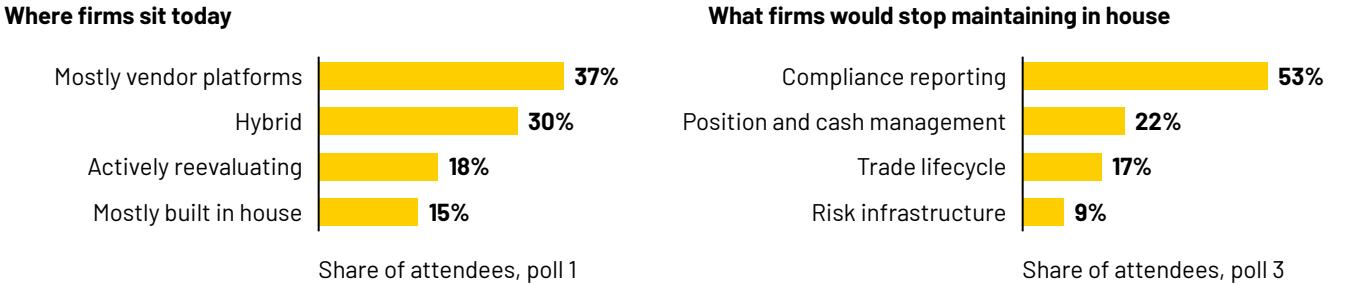
Source: the press releases, documentation and job posting in the Receipt column, as of October 2026. Aladdin has only a job posting that mentions MCP[60]. The LSEG customer count is from a secondary summary[50]. Among system-of-record rivals, only SimCorp and Arcesium have an AI announcement in my sources. State Street, Clearwater and Bloomberg have none, so they are not listed.

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** A public account of the Copilot plugin model would cover production Aladdin APIs, the same ones Studio exposes, each user's own permissions, and tested no-advice guardrails[3, 10]. That account answers three governance questions: who can call what, with which permissions, and under which guardrails.

# 4. Buyers at BlackRock's own webinar said they want a core platform plus their own builds

BlackRock ran a Build vs. Buy webinar for asset managers and polled the attendees. The first poll asked where firms sit today. 37 percent said they run "mostly vendor platforms," 30 percent run a "hybrid," 18 percent are "actively reevaluating," and 15 percent are "mostly built in house"[2]. The second poll asked what is driving the build-or-buy decision. "AI and data demands" led at 42 percent; cost and speed to market tied for second[2]. The third poll asked what they would stop maintaining in house. 53 percent chose compliance reporting[2].

**Exhibit 13. Webinar attendees mostly run vendor or hybrid platforms and would stop maintaining compliance reporting in house first**




Source: poll results read out on the Build vs. Buy webinar, from the replay's published captions[2].

> "What's the API suite that you have? Are you using connectors to Snowflake or to Databricks? And I think that that part of the RFP has become much more prominent."
>
> — Clark Schafer, Partner, Alpha FMC, on the Build vs. Buy webinar[2]

Alisha Sewdass, BlackRock's Head of Aladdin Solutions Engineering, Americas, gave BlackRock's side on the same webinar. She described the shift of the last two years. It is "to more of a modular approach where clients are looking for that backbone foundational data that supports both publics and privates workflows." That comes, she said, with "very, very robust APIs that manage the end to end life cycle of a transaction." Those APIs let clients build "their secret sauce rebalancing tools" on top[2]. On AI, she said, "you need that system of record that underpins anything that AI is built upon." She also said "the other layer that is almost equally important is a really defined system of work"[2].

Rivals are selling to the same buyer, the one who wants a core platform plus their own builds. SimCorp announced wins at AllianceBernstein in February 2026 and Pictet in May 2026. AllianceBernstein keeps its "specialized in-house technology," and Pictet connects its own tools to SimCorp One by API[61, 62]. BlackRock's own August 2026 insight page says the same: "Build vs buy is no longer a binary question"[63].

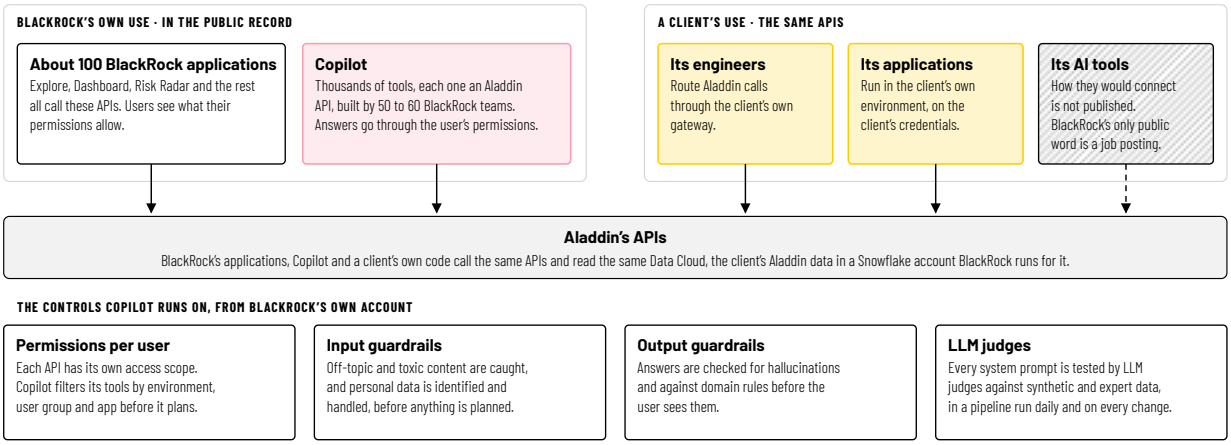
> **What this finding suggests about direction.** Buyers now ask in RFPs whether they can build on the platform. Studio is the right kind of answer.

Part 3

# Directions to explore

The findings point to one way of presenting Studio: the APIs, data and controls BlackRock's own teams build on, offered to a client's engineers as exactly that. The buyer is the client's engineering and data team; the proof is BlackRock's own use.

## Exhibit 14. BlackRock's own applications and a client's can run on the same APIs, data and controls




■ Solid boxes are in the public record. The hatched box is not: on a client's AI tools BlackRock has published nothing beyond a job posting [60]. Sources: Rosales and Valdez [3], the Copilot page [10], pull requests 52 and 53 [32, 33], the SDK README [17], the public specifications [11], the Data Cloud page [13], Woodhead [1] and Fivetran [16].

## Exhibit 15. Five pieces of marketing work that follow

| The work | What it is | How to know it worked |
|---|---|---|
| **An answer for RFPs** | A ready answer to "what APIs do you have, and can we connect to them": the APIs by area with their package labels, how permissions work, how a client routes calls through its own gateway, and the Snowflake and Databricks answer | Time to answer the API section of an RFP; RFPs that score Studio; how many of those are won |
| **A public explanation of how Copilot's tools work** | A page on which APIs Copilot's tools call, whose permissions apply, what stops it giving advice, and how a client's AI tools would connect | The page is published and dated; prospects stop asking about connectors in deal reviews |
| **One client willing to be named** | One client story, cleared for the Studio page and the RFP answer: a public pension fund already on record, or a client whose engineers have contributed to the SDK | Named clients sales can cite; deals in which one is cited |
| **A worked example: compliance reporting** | A page and a demo of compliance reporting on Data Cloud and the compliance APIs, the task webinar attendees would stop running in house first | Meetings that open on this example; pipeline tagged to it |
| **A worked example: private-markets data** | A page and a demo of a custom application using Preqin and eFront data from a client's Data Cloud | Clients with Data Cloud who take the private-markets data; use in client meetings |

■ Source: my proposals, built on Exhibit 14 and the findings in Part 2.

Part 4

# What I could not see

Everything here was read from outside, which limits what this document can be sure of. Exhibit 16 follows a prospect's engineer through six steps, from first hearing about Studio to getting help. For each step it records what is public today and what a client receives after qualification. I could read the pages, unpack the specifications and read the SDK's code. I could not run anything, open the catalog, guides, notebooks or samples, or test what a client receives; where this document describes those, it relies on what sources say.

**Exhibit 16. What I was not able to see from outside, and what opens after qualification**

| Step | Public today | After qualification | Receipt |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Hear** | Podcasts, webinar replays, client videos and conference talks on BlackRock's site and partner channels | Client forums and the solutions team | the Never Done podcast[22], the Big Little Questions video series[23], Woodhead[1], Rosales and Valdez[3] |
| **Read** | The Studio page ("Create & automate," "Make Aladdin your own," "Align internally & externally") and the APIs page, which promises "dozens of APIs" | The Developer Portal and the API framework guides | Studio page[7], APIs page[18] |
| **See the catalog** | The 54 specifications, but only by unpacking the 11 PyPI add-on packages | The API catalog and the Data Dictionary | asdk_plugin packages[11], APIs page[18] |
| **Try** | Nothing to run: no public sandbox or trial is offered | Studio Compute; an API token or an OAuth application "registered via Studio UI"; and the client's own Aladdin host to call | SDK README[17] |
| **Build** | The open-source SDK on GitHub and PyPI, with a detailed README; the plugin builder | A client host and credentials, which the SDK needs for every call | SDK README[17], PyPI history[64], plugin builder[21] |
| **Get help** | GitHub issues and pull requests on the SDK, answered by BlackRock engineers; on the Studio page, "Book a meeting" and "Download the brochure" | Notebooks, code samples, support | Pull request 52[32], pull request 57[65], Studio page[7] |

■ Source: the pages and repositories in the Receipt column, read with no account or login, October 2026. The After qualification column is what those sources say a client receives; I did not test it.

The SDK is the one piece of Studio a prospect can install before any conversation. Its README documents three run modes: "a developer's local machine," "Aladdin Studio Compute sessions" and a test mode. It stores a prompted password in the operating system's credential manager. It carries settings for firms that consume "the Aladdin APIs via an enterprise API management platform such as Azure API Management"[17].

## Exhibit 17. Investment platforms, Studio among them, open to developers only after a relationship exists

2: Fully public or self-serve  1: Partial or after sign-up or approval  0: None or blocked

| Platform | Public docs | API catalog | Trial or sandbox | First API call without a contract | Sample code | Community or marketplace | AI connector | Call to action |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Investment platforms** | | | | | | | | |
| Bloomberg | 1 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 1 |
| **Aladdin Studio** | **1** | **1** | **0** | **0** | **1** | **1** | **0** | **0** |
| State Street | 1 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 1 |
| Arcesium | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 2 | 0 |
| SimCorp | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 0 |
| Clearwater | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 0 |
| **Data and cloud platforms** | | | | | | | | |
| Snowflake | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 |
| Databricks | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 |
| LSEG | 1 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 1 |
| FactSet | 2 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 0 |
| MSCI | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 0 |

For the AI connector score: 2 means a connector that outside AI tools can use, such as an MCP server. 1 means one announced or in limited release. 0 means none, or an assistant that works only inside the vendor's own platform.

Source: my test of each platform's public pages[7, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 52, 54, 56], no accounts or payments, October 8, 2026. Bloomberg, Clearwater and MSCI may score lower than they deserve, because some of their pages blocked automated access.

Exhibit 17 puts Studio beside 10 platforms that a Studio buyer also deals with[66, 67, 68]. It scores each on eight things a developer with no client relationship can reach: 2 where the vendor opens it before any sale, 0 where access follows a relationship. The pattern is each vendor's selling model. Investment platforms cluster low because they gate. At Aladdin, as at Bloomberg, State Street, SimCorp, Clearwater and Arcesium, documentation, a sandbox and a first call come after a relationship exists. Data and cloud platforms sell to developers directly and cluster high.

# About this document

This is an independent analysis compiled from public sources. The sources are BlackRock product pages, SEC filings, procurement notices, public code and packages on GitHub and PyPI, press releases, job postings, and transcripts of BlackRock recordings. BlackRock did not produce, review or endorse it. Facts are as of October 19, 2026, unless an exhibit gives another date.

AI agents pulled the pages, unpacked the packages, transcribed the recordings and drafted the text. I checked each claim against the document or recording it cites.

Underlined text links to the document behind each fact. Superscripts point to the Sources section, which follows this page and gives each source's grade (P, S or T), title, speaker and date.

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# Sources

Sources are numbered in the order they are first cited, then grouped into three grades, so the numbers within a group are not consecutive. P is a primary document. S is a BlackRock speaker on the record, with name and title as the recording gives them. T is a third-party report. For recordings, each entry gives the minute and second at which each quoted passage begins. "Machine transcription" means speech-to-text software run locally on the downloaded audio. "Auto-captions" means YouTube's captions. Both can mishear names and jargon. Inside quotations, the only correction made was to the spelling of proper names the captions got wrong.

### P. Primary documents


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11 P **asdk_plugin_* add-on packages, version 2.0.0b3 (11 packages holding 54 Swagger 2.0 specifications)**. PyPI, unpacked October 2026. https://pypi.org/search/?q=asdk_plugin

12 P **iShares V plc prospectus (Aladdin Provider fees paid by service providers)**. BlackRock, 2026. https://www.blackrock.com/uk/literature/prospectus/ishares-v-plc-prospectus-en.pdf

13 P **Aladdin Data Cloud product page**. BlackRock, as of October 2026. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/platforms/products/aladdin-data-cloud

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22 P **Never Done, the Aladdin podcast series page**. BlackRock Aladdin, as of October 2026. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover/expertise/never-done-podcast-by-aladdin

23 P **Big Little Questions, video series page**. BlackRock Aladdin, as of October 2026. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover/expertise/big-little-questions

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**54** P **Arcesium launches comprehensive AI platform**. Arcesium press release, 2026. https://www.arcesium.com/press-release/arcesium-launches-comprehensive-ai-platform

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## S. BlackRock speakers on the record


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**2** S **Build vs. buy: how asset managers are rethinking key decisions (webinar replay; published captions)**. Michael Campos, US asset manager coverage, and Alisha Sewdass, Head of Aladdin Solutions Engineering, Americas, BlackRock, with Clark Schafer, Partner, Alpha FMC. Replay page undated. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover/expertise/webinars/build-vs-buy-how-asset-managers-are-rethinking-key-decisions Quoted at 4:37, 4:40, 14:46, 24:34, 31:56, 32:01, 39:15, 39:42, 42:22, 47:41 (Sewdass at 31:56, 32:01, 39:15 and 39:42; Schafer at 42:22).

**3** S **How BlackRock built production AI agents for asset management with LangGraph (LangChain Interrupt 2025; machine transcription)**. Brennan Rosales, AI Engineering Lead, and Pedro Vicente Valdez, Principal AI Engineer, BlackRock, 2025. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oyqeCHFM5U4 Quoted at 1:33, 1:44, 1:53, 3:58, 4:31, 5:27, 6:42, 7:16, 7:22, 7:34, 10:30.

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**47** S **Unifying the whole portfolio across public and private markets (webinar replay; machine transcription)**. Melissa Faraz, Global Head of Business Development for Private Markets Analytics Platforms and Head of Preqin London. Paul McGaugh, Managing Director, Aladdin Private Markets Product. Cameron Skinner, Managing Director and Global Head of Solutions Engineering; all three at BlackRock, September 2025. https://www.blackrock.com/aladdin/discover/expertise/webinars/unifying-the-whole-portfolio-across-public-and-private-markets Quoted at 17:36, 19:21 (McGaugh), 20:51, 21:21 (Faraz).

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## T. Third-party reports

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